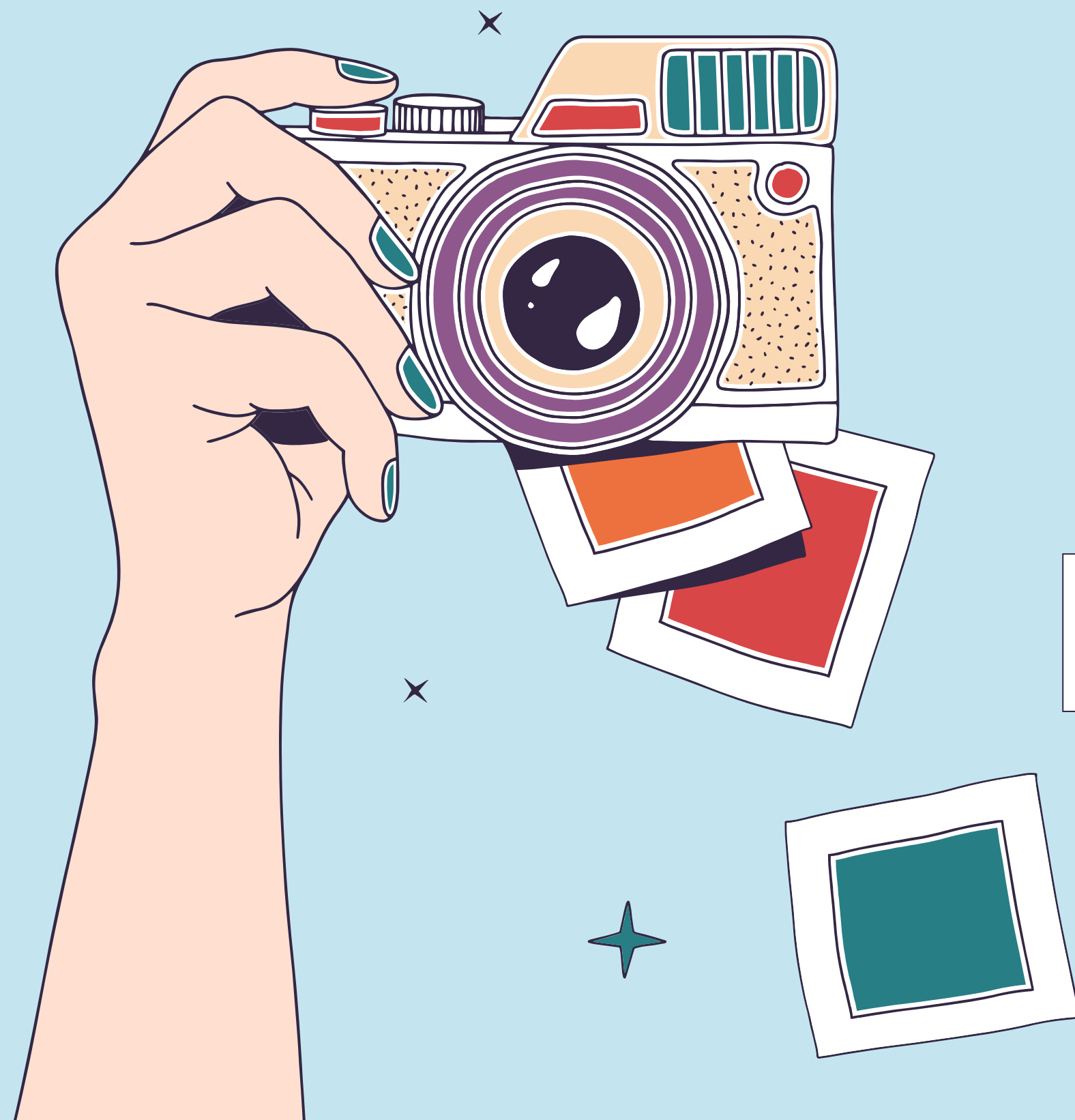
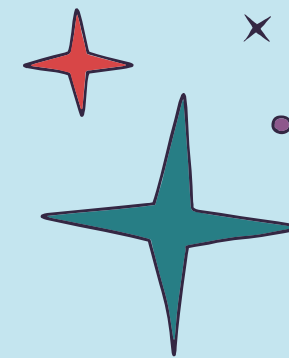
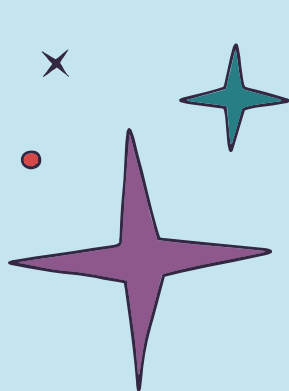




FRAME

Memories shouldn't be work!



Capturing moments is effortless,
remembering them isn't.



The people behind FRAME



GAVIN CAO

loves animals, food & nature
lowkey a farmer :)



RACHIT GUPTA

loves to drive, travel, and
click pictures!!



ZEEL PATEL

loves to sleep, eat
and repeat



there are

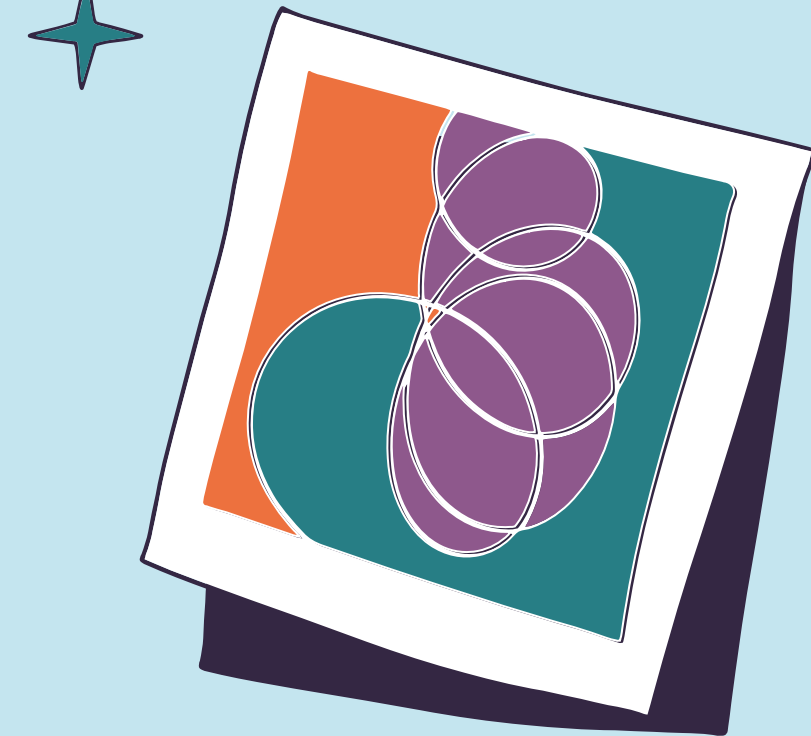
3000+

photos on almost every phone!

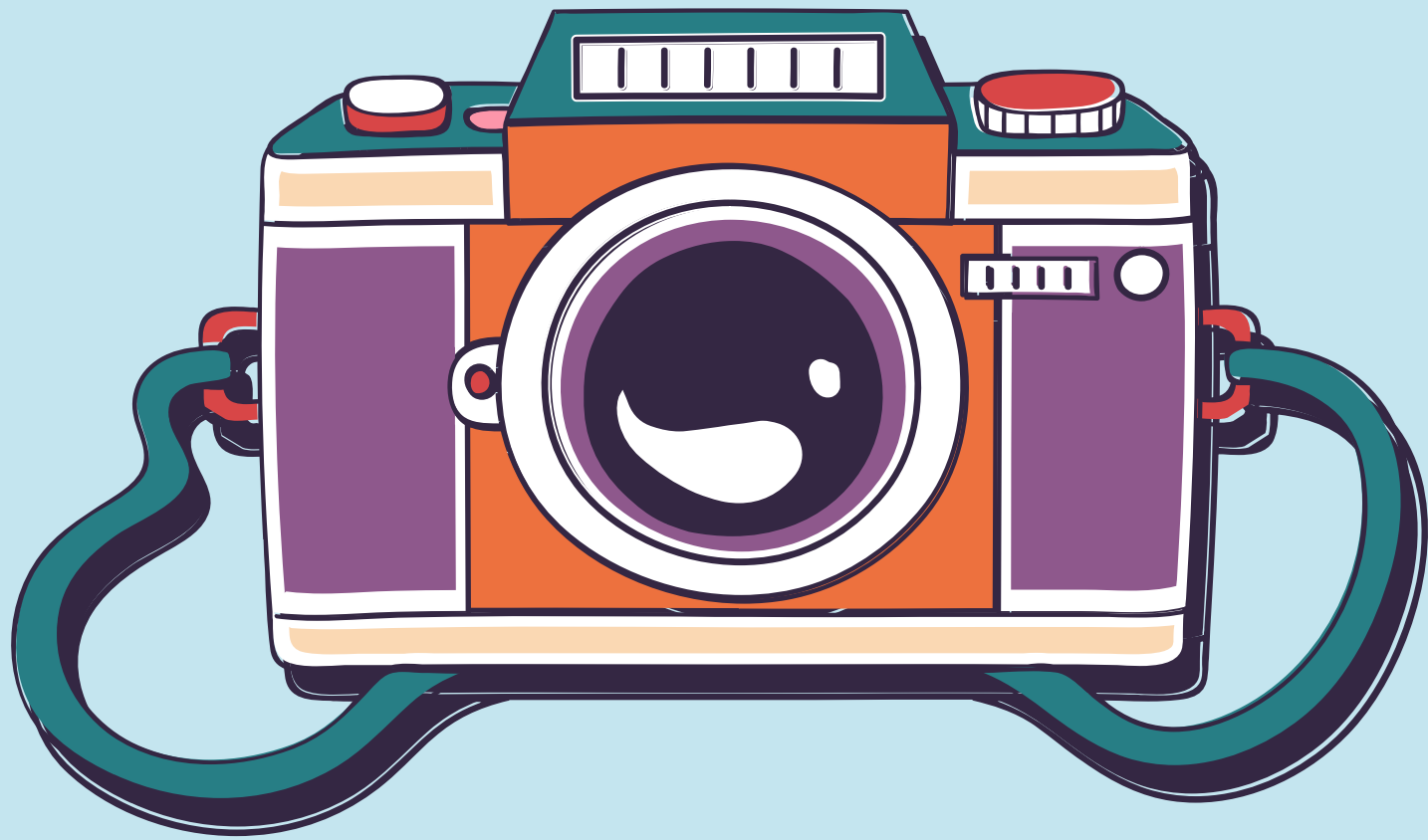
we take more photos than ever

People frequently capture shared experiences together such as trips, parties, or events but there is no reliable, cross-platform way to collect photos from everyone involved and meaningfully organize them afterward.

Photos end up scattered across iOS and Android devices, messaging apps, and cloud links, making it difficult to find important moments, filter through large volumes of content, or view photos at full quality.



where things start to break



- Shared moments often include people using both iOS and Android, yet photo sharing still breaks across platforms
- Photos end up scattered across apps (AirDrop, group chats, cloud links)
- Important photos are often buried under duplicates or low-quality images
- Finding specific moments or the best photos takes more effort than it should

to know more, we talked to



Ms. PURPLE

Insurance Industry Professional

Extreme user: Gen Z teen who uses both iOS and Android



Mr. RED

Game Developer

Average user: Millennial who uses Android devices only



Mr. GREEN

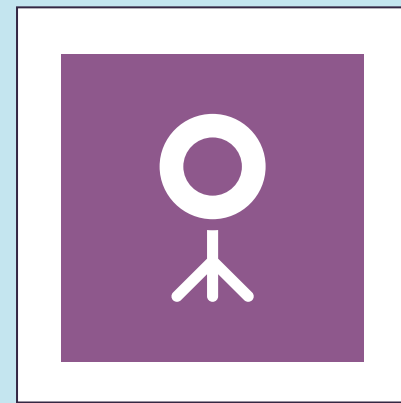
Researcher

Non-user: Gen Z teen who uses iOS devices only

yes, people are colors now....

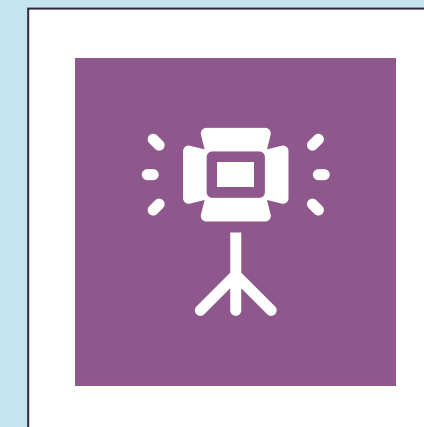
[PARTICIPANTS]

why these voices mattered



Variety in OS

People who use different operating systems, like iOS and Android (or even both)



Diverse Background

People of different age groups and genders, to ensure different perspectives

[WHY WERE THEY CHOSEN?]



we asked them to tell us stories

Can you tell us about a recent time where you
had to share photos with friends and family?

What did that process look like to you?

How do you decide what photos matter most to
you?

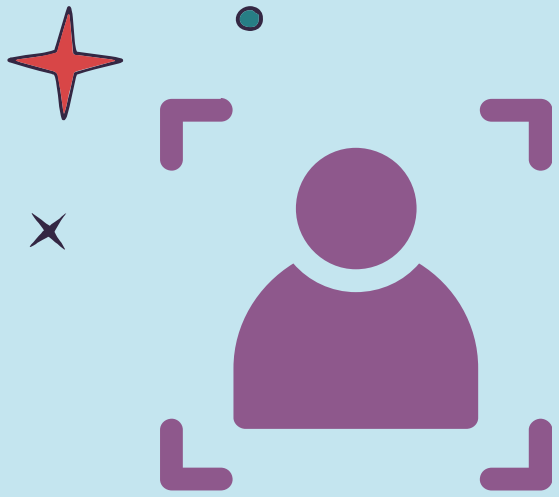
What did the photo sharing process look like
to you?

How often do you use shared albums?

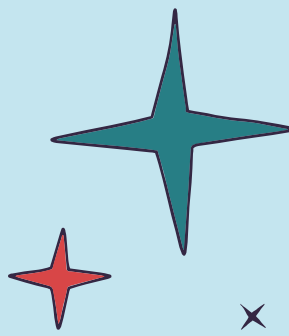
How often do you filter through the shared album
for photos more relevant to you?

How do you currently store or organize photos?

[GUIDING QUESTIONS]



meet ms. purple



Insurance industry professional, Gen Z
met at a Starbucks in Goleta

Extreme User: Uses both iOS and Android, frequent cross-platform photo sharing, relies on shared albums, encounters quality loss issues, manages photos after group events, mixed-device social groups

Lead: Zeel; Scribed: Gavin

“One of my roommates doesn't have an iPhone, and
that makes everything way more complicated.”



SAY

"It's more of a set-it-and-forget-it situation"
[Cloud Photo Backups]

"It's just easier to have everything in one place instead of everyone individually sending photos back and forth"

"One thing I actually really like is the facial recognition feature"

"I'm mostly looking for photos of myself"

"It's more about how the photo feels than how it looks technically. It's very mood-based"
[Photo Preference]

"One of my roommates doesn't have an iPhone, and that makes everything way more complicated"

"It's already there, it works fine, and I'm used to how it's organized"
[Default Photos App]

"I wouldn't really say I'm a big photo person compared to other people my age"

"It feels frustrating that sharing photos between different phones still isn't seamless"

"As long as I can find things when I need to, I'm fine with it"

"I take a lot of photos with friends"

"iMessage completely ruins the quality of photos and videos, so I avoid that"

"I use shared albums pretty often"

DO

Backup gives peace of mind

Auto-organization removes work from her

Android roommate complicates everything

Cross-platform sharing should be seamless

Would switch if it were harder to use

Centralized albums are easier than individual sharing

Sharing with Android is tedious

Instagram is convenient but not for keepers

Facial recognition is super helpful

Precise date filters would help

Email has file limits

purple's empathy map

THINK

Takes photos situationally (trips, friends) not daily

Uses Google Photos as passive backup

Sticks with default gallery app [Did not find it necessary to switch]

Creates shared albums for group events

Saves self-photos from shared albums to personal album

Takes photos with friends doing fun activities

Does NOT actively monitor backup

Does not organize photos into folders [Cloud Folders]

Has never downloaded a separate photo app

Avoids iMessage and Instagram for quality-sensitive sharing

AirDrops to iPhone users

Uploads to Google Photos then sends link to Android user

FEEL

Frustration about cross-platform sharing

Likes knowing photos are backed up

Finds auto-organization helpful

Frustration when sharing with Android roommate

Annoyance about quality loss [Messaging/Cloud Storage]

Likes facial recognition

Doesn't like using Instagram for photos to keep



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she taught us that

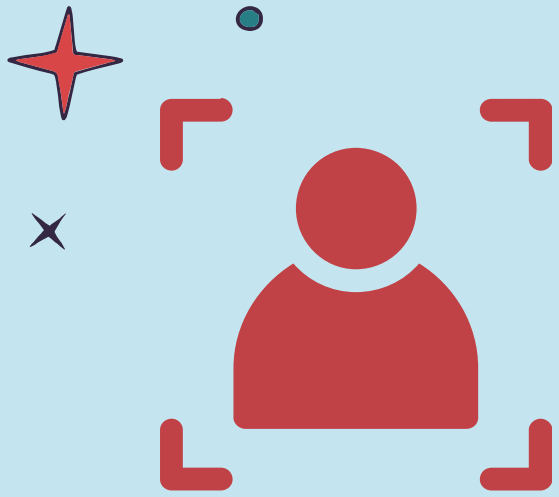
Purple's sharing issues aren't about taking or storing photos; it's about what happens after the moment. She's become an informal "platform translator" for her friend group, juggling AirDrop for iPhone friends and Google Photos links for her Android roommate. A typical night out gets interrupted by a logistics problem. Quality loss through iMessage isn't just a technical annoyance. It feels like the memory itself is being degraded. Purple wants sharing to feel like an extension of the moment, not a chore that follows it.

insights

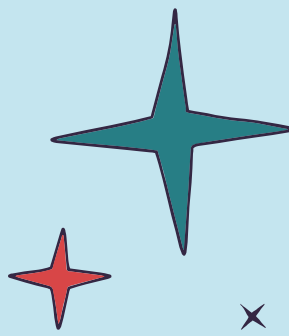
need

Users need to share full-quality photos with mixed-device groups in one step, because current workarounds (cloud links, compressed messaging) turn a social act into tedious work.





meet mr. red

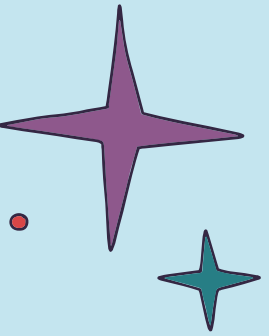


Game developer, Millennial
met on the streets of New York

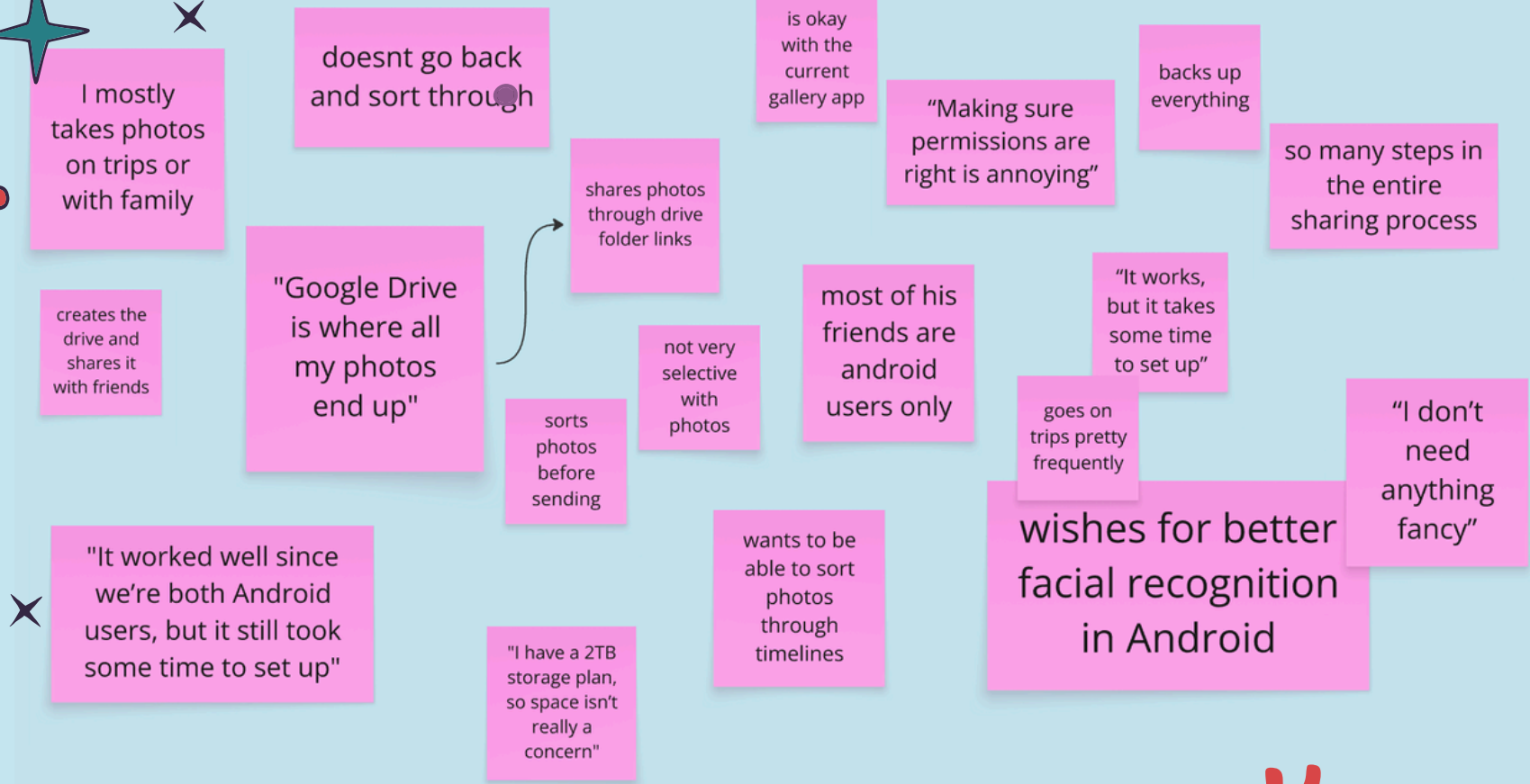
Average User: UsePrimarily Android user, occasional photo-taking (mostly trips), relies on cloud storage, uses default gallery app, shares via Google Drive folders, minimal photo curation, low use of advanced features

Lead: Rachit; Scribed: Zeel

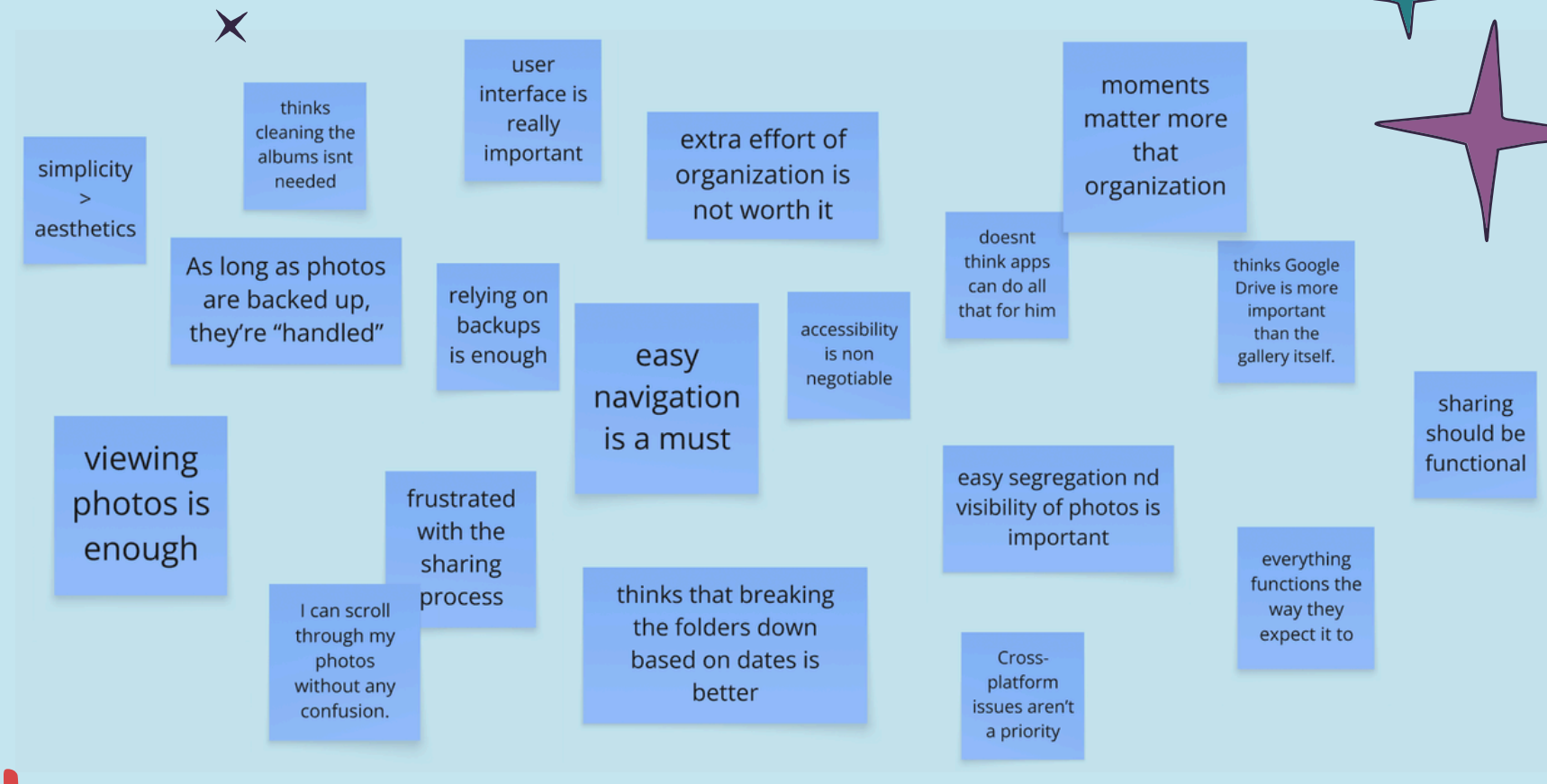
“It worked well since we're both Android users, but it
still took some time to set up.”



SAY

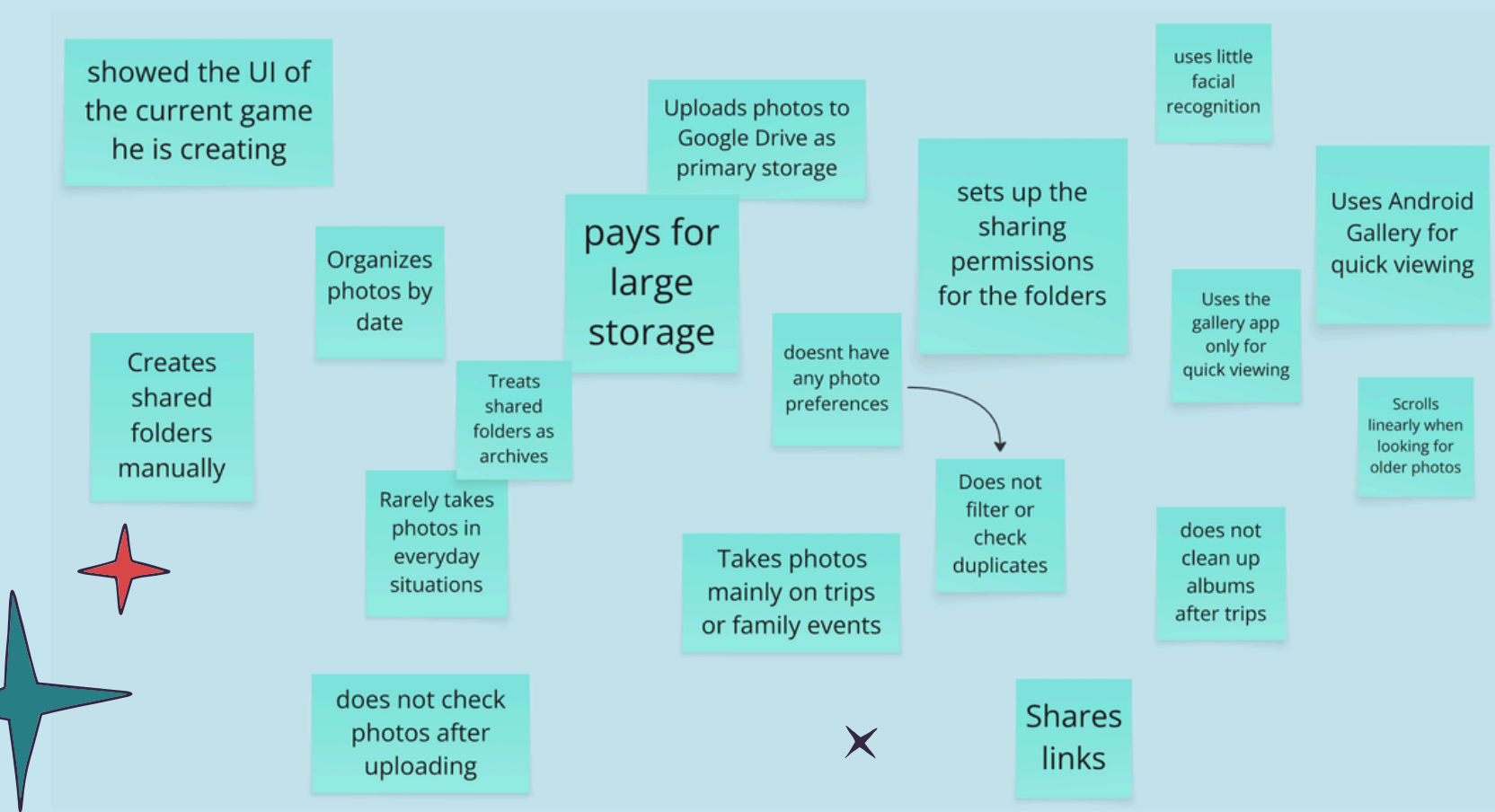


DO



red's empathy map

THINK



FEEL



SAY

DO

red's empathy map

THINK

FEEL

I mostly takes photos on trips or with family

doesn't go back and sort through

is okay with the current gallery app

"Making sure permissions are right is annoying"

backs up everything

so many steps in the entire sharing process

creates the drive and shares it with friends

"Google Drive is where all my photos end up"

shares photos through drive folder links

not very selective with photos

most of his friends are android users only

"It works, but it takes some time to set up"

goes on trips pretty frequently

wishes for better facial recognition in Android

"I don't need anything fancy"

"It worked well since we're both Android users, but it still took some time to set up"

"I have a 2TB storage plan, so space isn't really a concern"

wants to be able to sort photos through timelines

simplicity > aesthetics

As long as photos are backed up, they're "handled"

relying on backups is enough

easy navigation is a must

accessibility is non negotiable

doesn't think apps can do all that for him

moments matter more than organization

thinks Google Drive is more important than the gallery itself.

sharing should be functional

everything functions the way they expect it to

easy segregation and visibility of photos is important

Cross-platform issues aren't a priority

thinks that breaking the folders down based on dates is better

frustrated with the sharing process

I can scroll through my photos without any confusion.

viewing photos is enough

showed the UI of the current game he is creating

Uploads photos to Google Drive as primary storage

uses little facial recognition

sets up the sharing permissions for the folders

Uses Android Gallery for quick viewing

Uses the gallery app only for quick viewing

Scrolls linearly when looking for older photos

does not clean up albums after trips

Does not filter or check duplicates

Takes photos mainly on trips or family events

Shares links

does not check photos after uploading

Rarely takes photos in everyday situations

Treats shared folders as archives

Organizes photos by date

pays for large storage

doesn't have any photo preferences

Creates shared folders manually

Hates the lack of structure

Calm knowing his photos are safely backed up

Comfortable with familiar tools

Accepts friction

Feels photos are more sentimental

Would appreciate improvement if it required no extra effort

Slightly annoyed when managing permissions

not too concerned with inefficiency

Mildly frustrated during the sharing setup process

slightly drained by repetitive setup tasks

Neutral about taking photos

Mildly inconvenienced but not enough to make an issue out of it

Feels no urgency to clean up after the trips are over

Detached from shared albums after sharing

no attachment to revisit albums

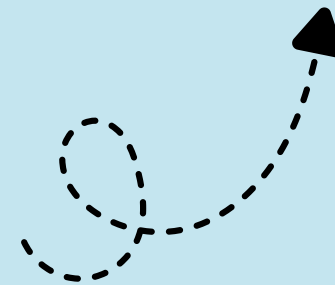
he taught us that

Red doesn't have strong complaints, but that is the problem. He's accepted difficulties as the normal cost of sharing. Setting up permissions and organizing folders after his San Diego trip wasn't overly painful but just tedious enough to drain his motivation. Once photos are dumped into a Drive folder, he never revisits them. The current tools don't fail dramatically. They quietly discourage engagement. His photos become archives, not memories.



Users need photo sharing that requires zero configuration, because even small setup tasks (permissions, folders, links) create enough friction to turn active memory-sharing into passive storage.

need



insights



meet mr. green

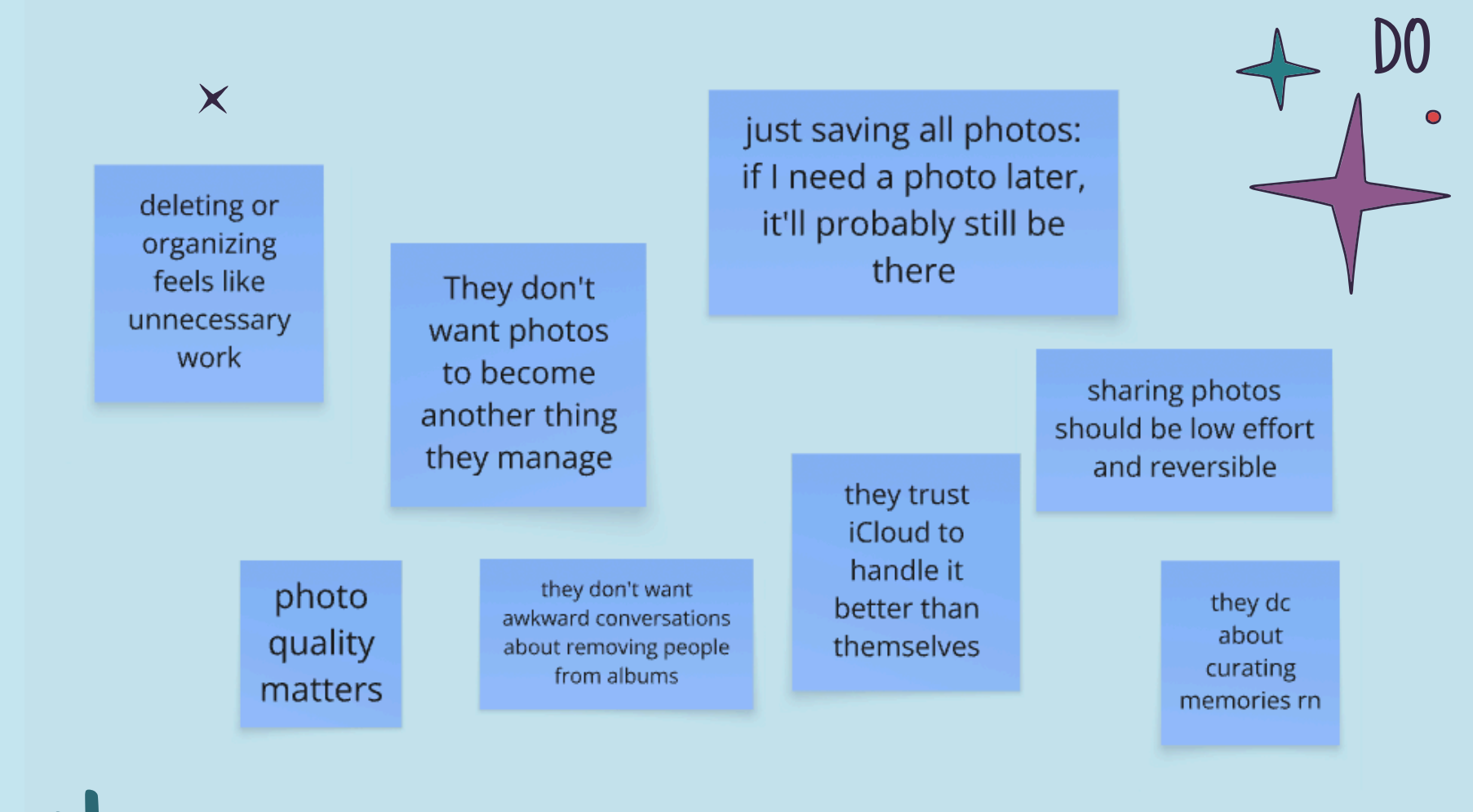
Researcher, Gen Z
met at his company

Non User: Primarily iOS-only user, minimal photo-taking behavior, relies entirely on iCloud automation, shares photos through iMessage, does not engage with shared albums, avoids manual organization or curation

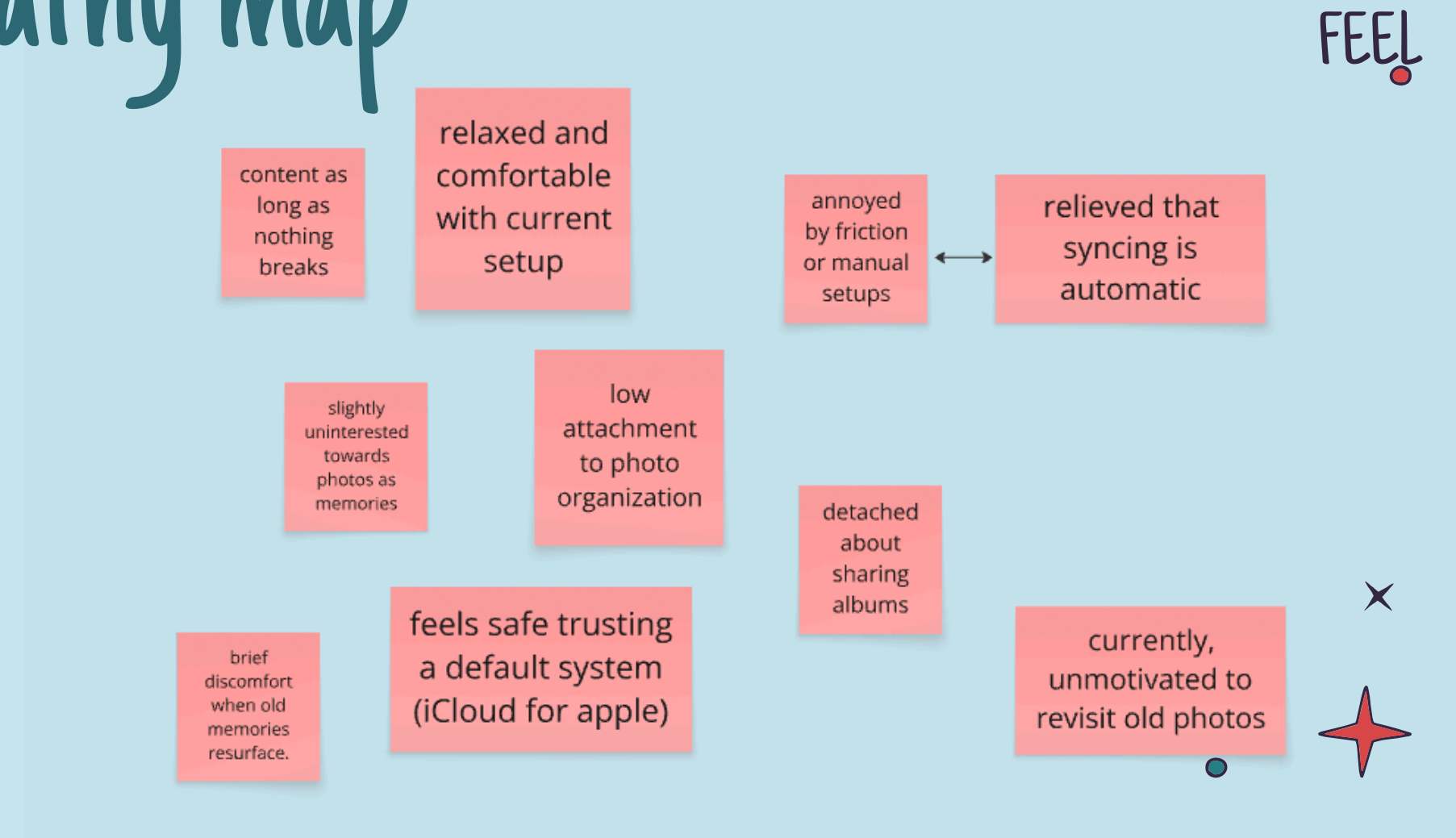
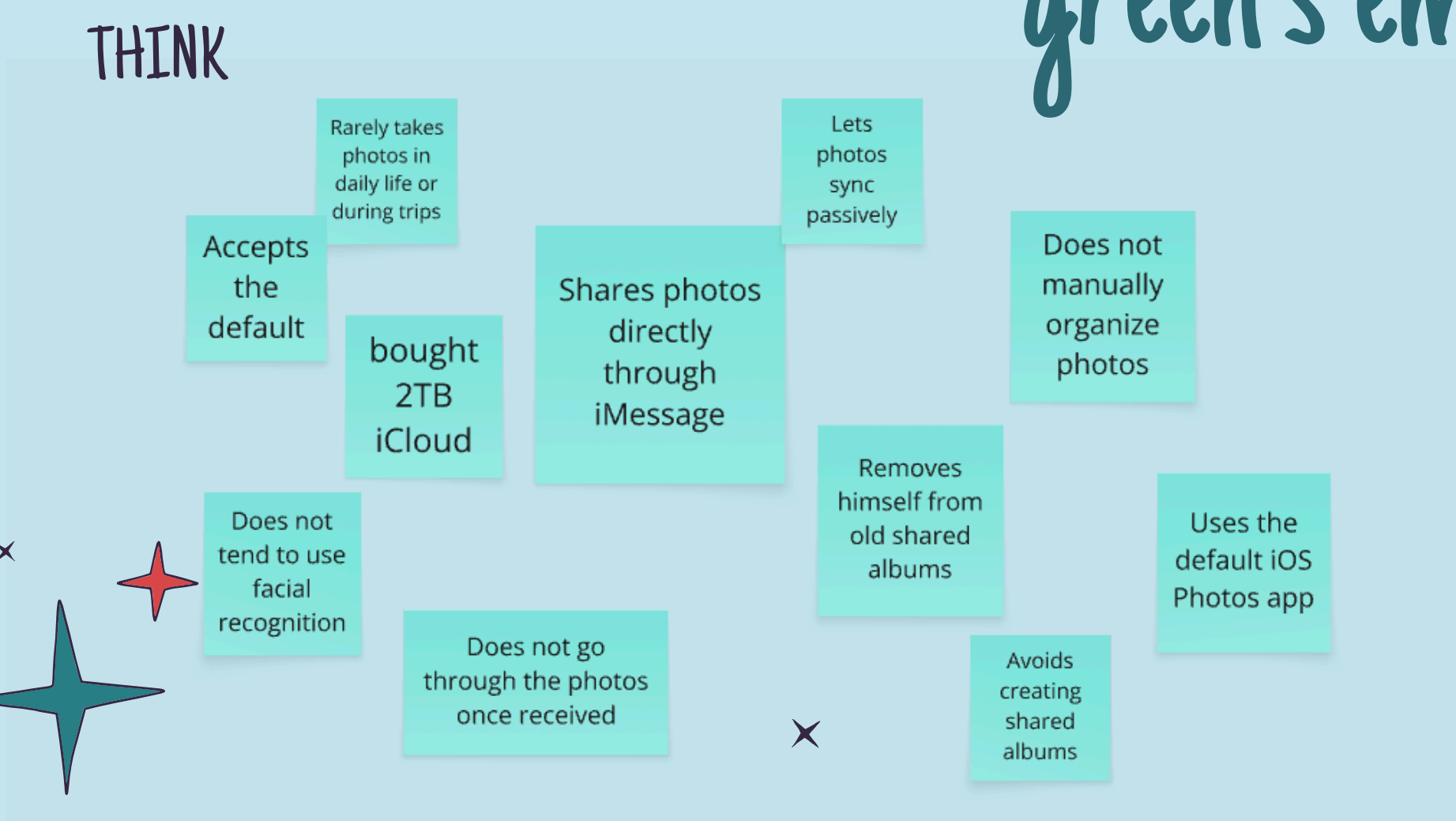
Lead: Gavin; Scribed: Rachit

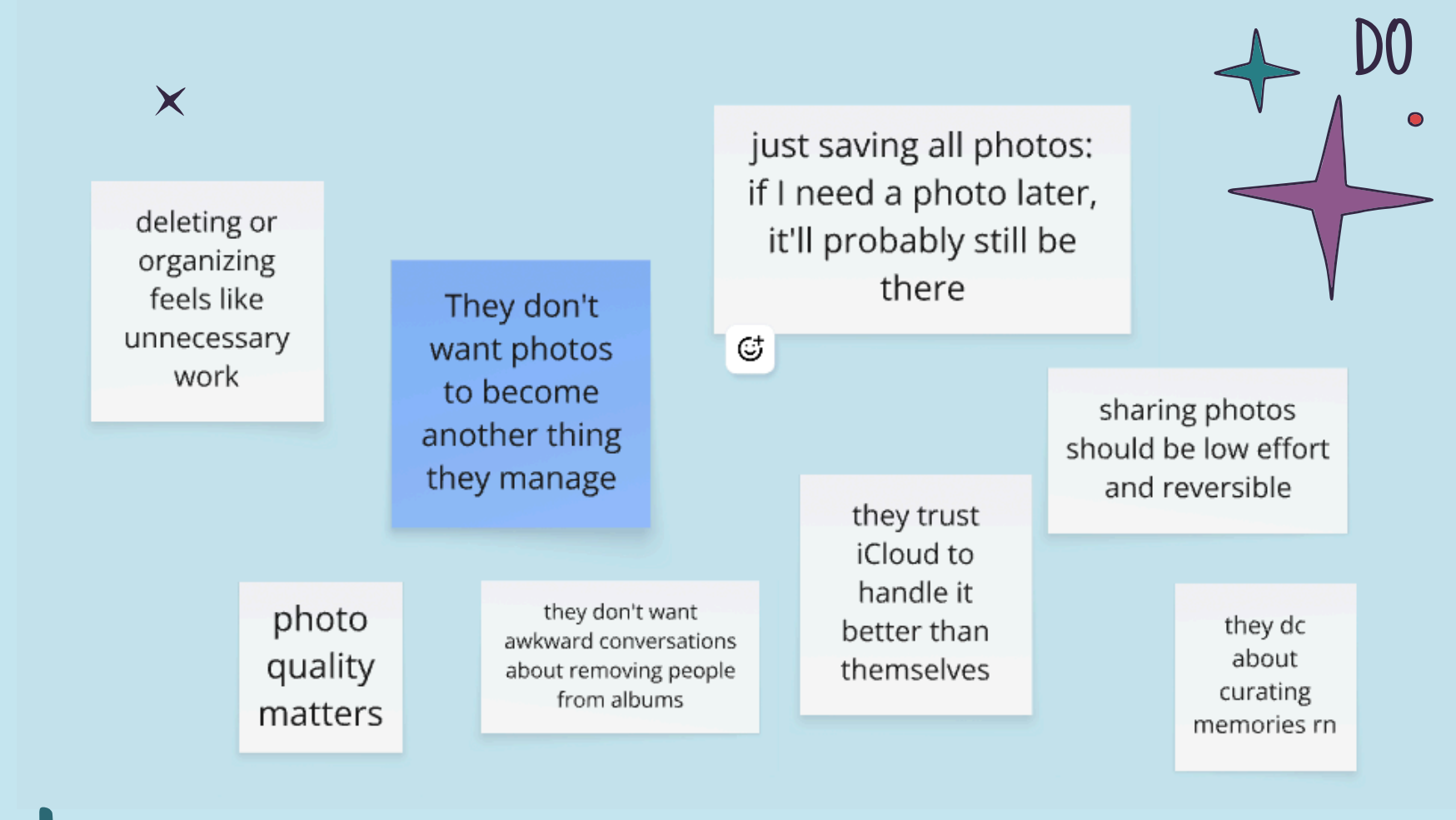
"There's no quality distortion when everyone has an iPhone.
The only time quality drops is when it switches to SMS."



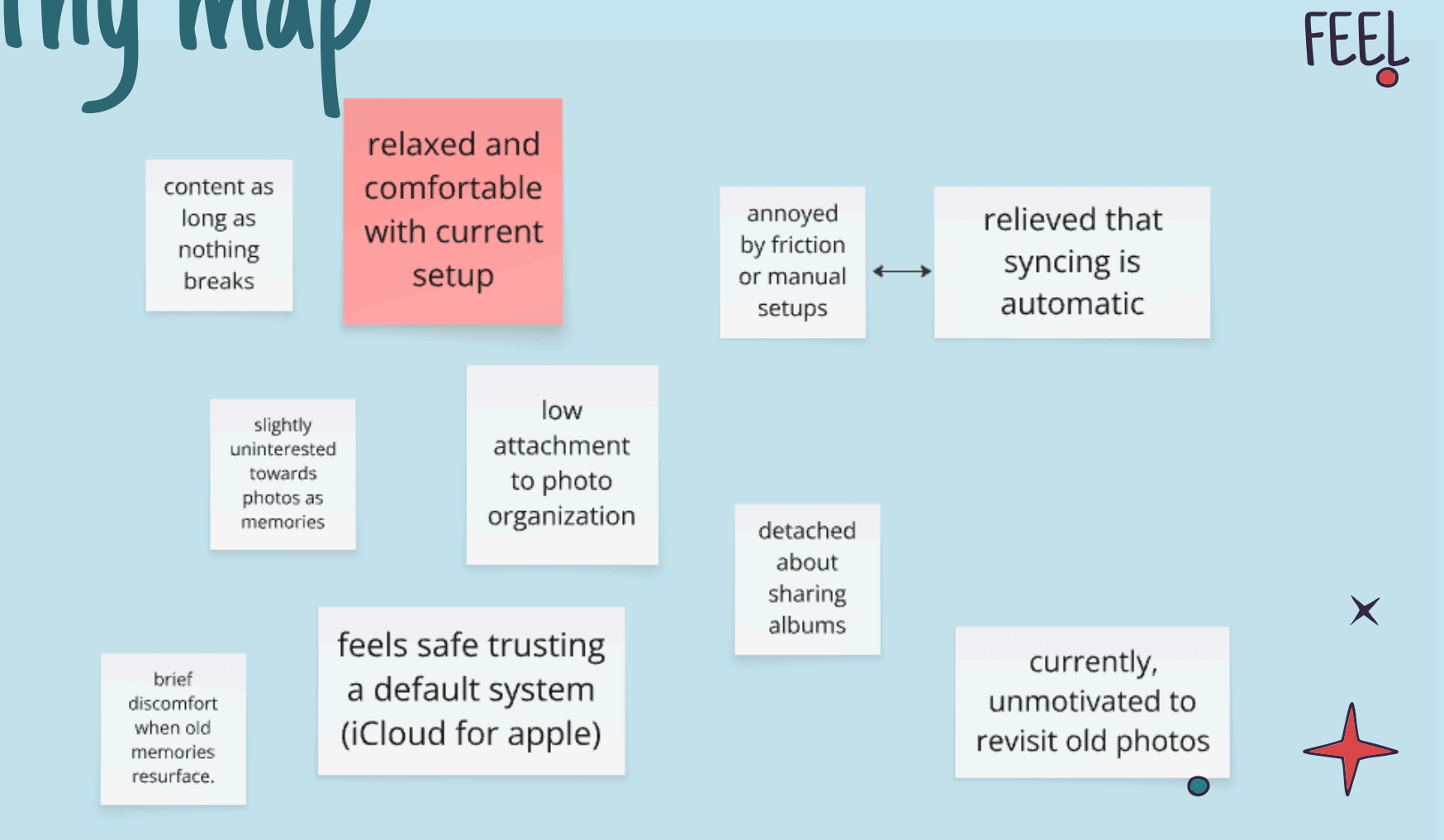
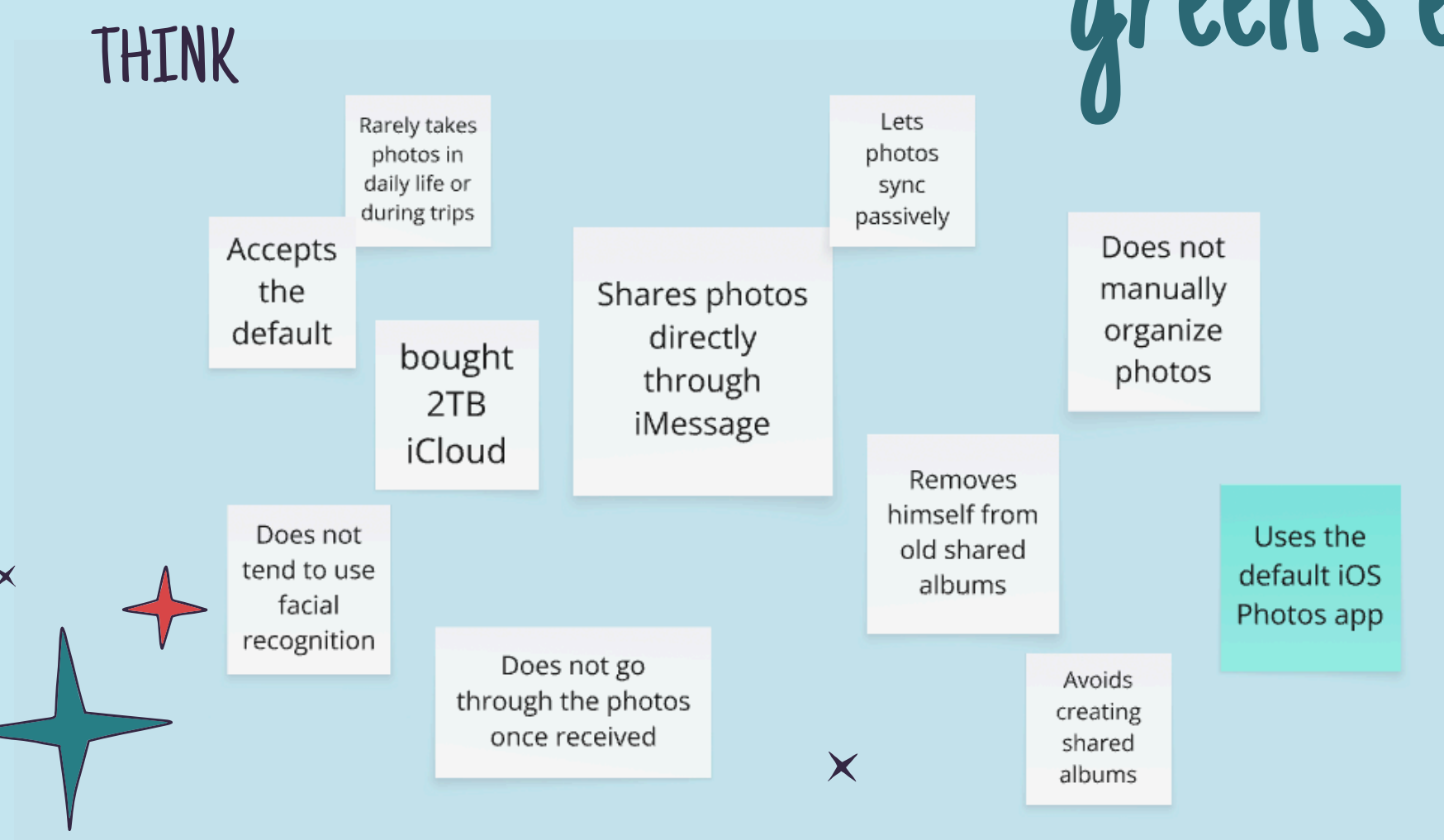


green's empathy map





green's empathy map



he taught us that

Green experiences photo sharing as solved. iMessage and iCloud give him seamless transfers with zero effort, but only because everyone he shares with also has an iPhone. He's unaware of the friction his friends who use Android would face because he never encounters it. His frictionless experience is exclusionary by design. Apple's ecosystem works by pushing incompatibility problems onto whoever falls outside it. Users like Green aren't potential customers however, they are the standard the app needs to match.

insights



need

Users need cross-platform sharing that matches the ease of same-ecosystem tools. The current gap creates a subpar experience where "wrong device" users suffer.

Camera shy 🚫
Consent respected 💖

listening across all three stories

CROSS PLATFORM FRICTION	Photo sharing works smoothly only within the same OS; mixed iOS-Android groups rely on workarounds that interrupt the experience.
AFTER THE MOMENT	The biggest pain point isn't taking photos, but collecting and managing them after shared experiences end.
MANUAL EFFORT	Setting up folders, permissions, and links adds just enough friction to discourage meaningful engagement.
SCATTERED PHOTOS	Photos are scattered across messaging apps, cloud links, and devices, making shared memories feel incomplete.
NEED FOR EASY ORGANIZATION	Users want photos to be automatically filtered and organized without needing to manage them themselves.
AI OPPORTUNITY	A cross-platform album with AI-driven organization can reduce effort and preserve shared memories.

what's coming up next

not a real calendar 🤔

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
		01	02	03	04	05
06	07	08	09	10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18	19
20	21	22	23	24	25	26
27	28	29	30	31		



GR1 revealed friction only becomes visible in mixed-device groups, so GR2 will expand interviews to confirm these patterns.



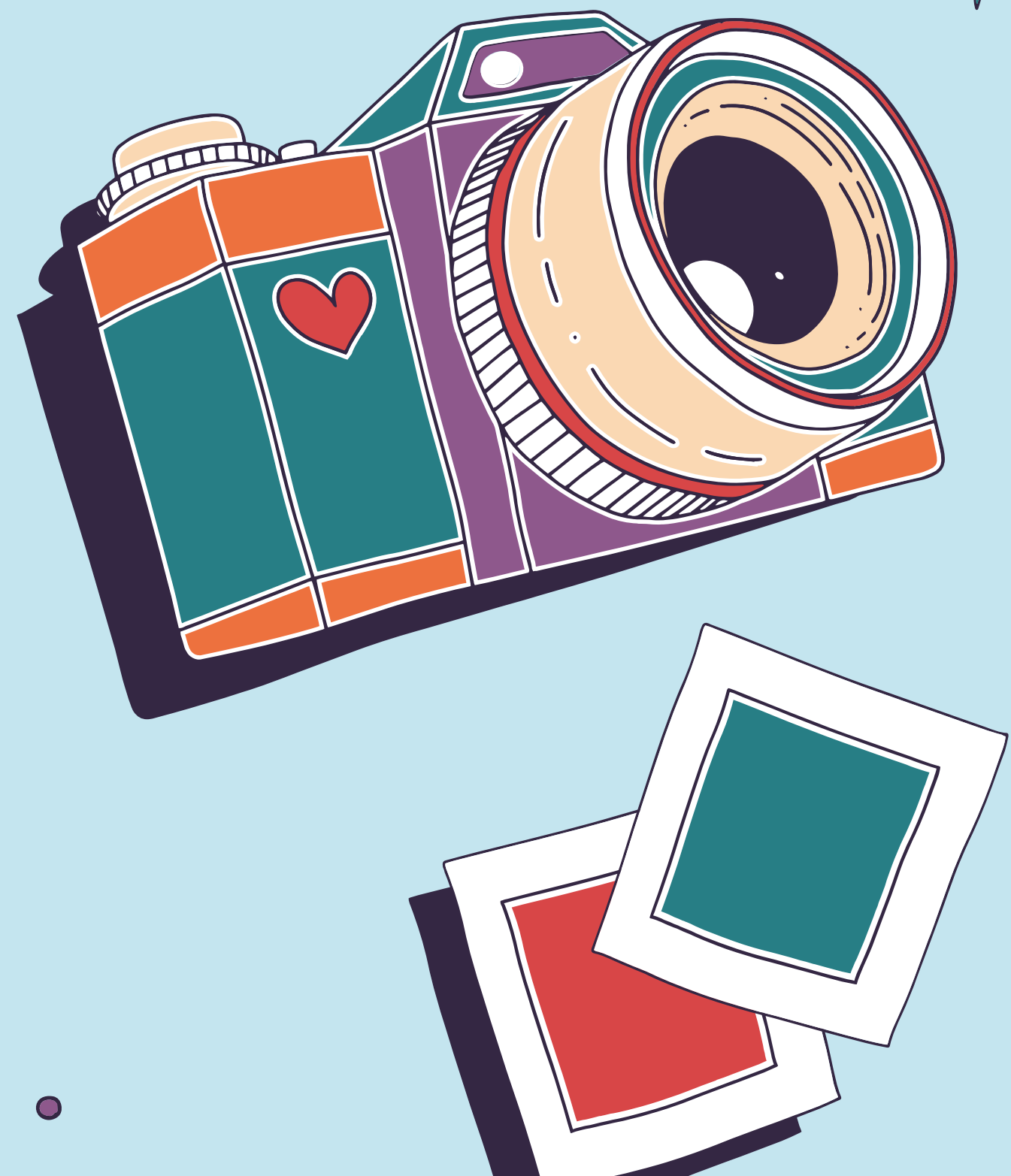
Insights from GR1 will be synthesized into clearer POVs and actionable How-Might-We questions in GR2.



Early empathy maps surfaced themes, but GR2 will refine them to distinguish real pain points from tolerated inconvenience.



With user needs grounded in GR1 research, GR2 will explore solution directions through structured ideation.



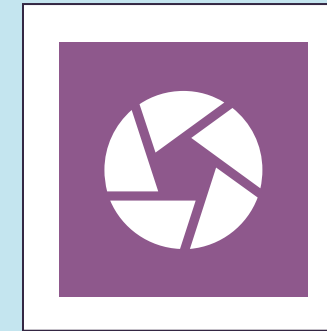
THANK YOU!

APPENDIX



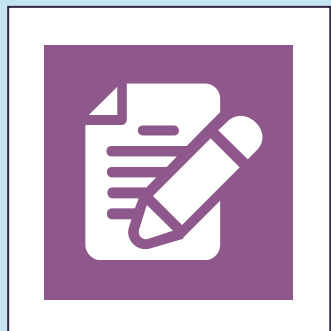
Participants

Gen Z and Millennial users across iOS, Android, and mixed-device groups



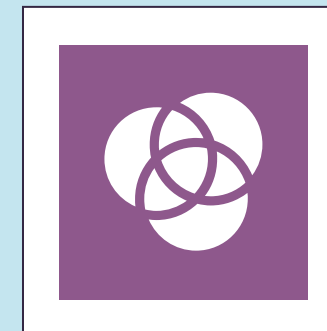
Focus

Post-event photo sharing and organization



Consent

Informed consent forms were signed by all participants



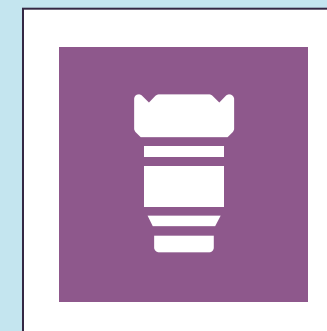
Synthesis

Insights derived using empathy mapping



Method

Semi-structured, story-based interviews



Scope

Exploratory research to inform ideation

to know more, we talked to



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Insurance Industry Professional

Extreme user: Gen Z teen who uses both iOS and Android



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Game Developer

Average user: Millennial who uses Android devices only



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Researcher

Non-user: Gen Z teen who uses iOS devices only

yes, people are colors now....